
Dangoor Plaza, Queen's Lawn, Imperial College Road, London SW7 2AZ

Heritage Statement



Project: Dangoor Plaza, Queen's Lawn, Imperial College Road, London SW7 2AZ

Client: Imperial College London

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Assumptions and Limitations

This report is compiled using primary and secondary information derived from a variety of sources, only some of which have been directly examined. The assumption is made that this data, as well as that derived from other secondary sources, is reasonably accurate.

Compliance

This document has been prepared in accordance with the requirements stated within the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF; (Department for Communities and Local Government, 2018)), updated in 2019, National Planning Practice Guidance (NPPG; (Department for Communities and Local Government)).

1.0 Introduction

1.1. Project background

- 1.1.1. This Heritage Statement has been researched and prepared by Savills Heritage Planning under commission of the Imperial College London to accompany the full planning and listed building consent application for proposed landscaping of Queen's Lawn, Imperial College Road, London SW7 2AZ (hereafter 'the Site'), located at NGR TQ 26637, 79291. An aerial view of the Site is shown at **Plate 1**.

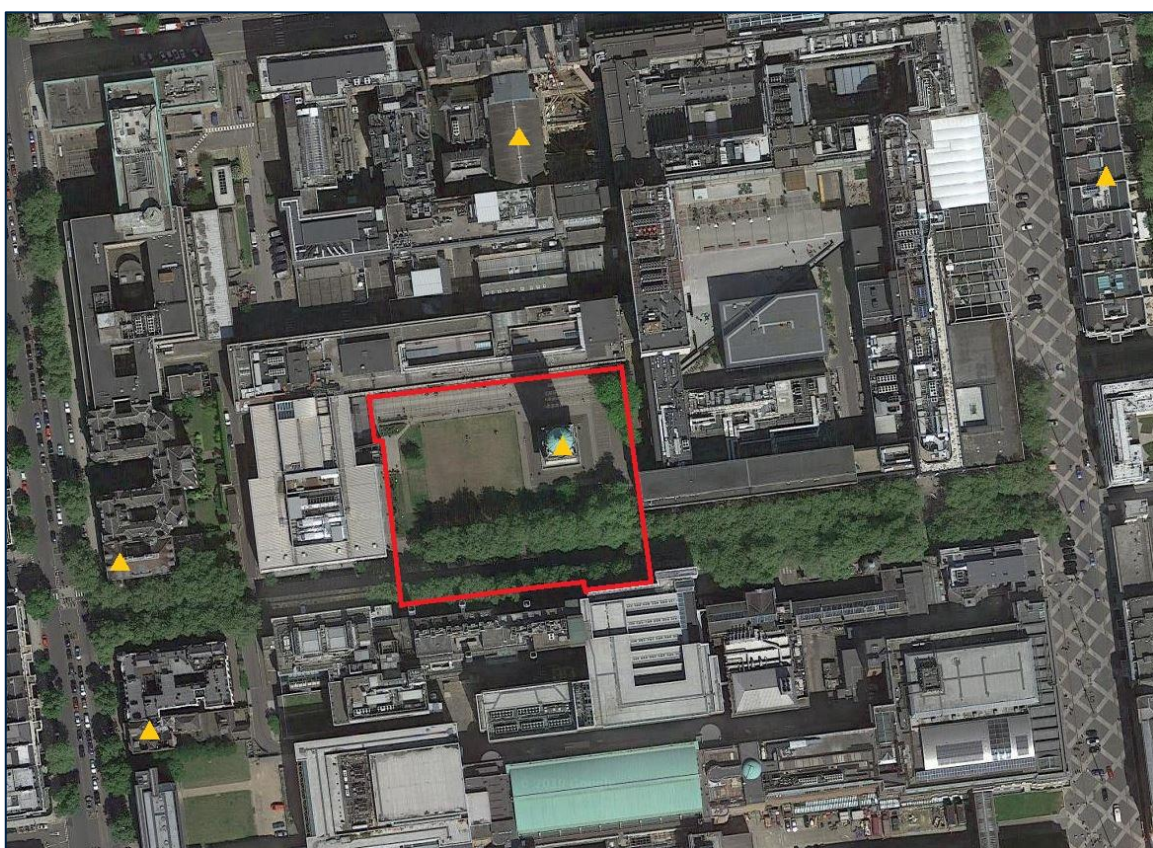


Plate 1 Aerial view of the Site (outlined in red) with the statutory listed buildings denoted in yellow, including the Grade II listed Queens Tower situated within the Site.. © Google Maps. 2019.

1.2. The Site and its wider context

- 1.2.1. The Site is located on the north side, and incorporates part of, Imperial College Road, which delineates its southern boundary, in the area of South Kensington, situated across the two boundaries of the London Borough of Westminster and The Royal Borough of Kensington and Chelsea (hereafter 'the Local Authorities' or 'the Council'). The Site is bounded by the institutional buildings of Imperial College

London to the north, east and west. The Site has had a long, continuous occupation as an educational institution set within an area of mixed use, with residential properties and museums lining Exhibition Road to the east, Cromwell Road to the south and Queens Gate to the west.

- 1.2.2. The Site comprises a public square currently known as Queen's Lawn to the north of Imperial College Road, which is also included within the proposals (see **Plates 2 to 9**). Situated at the eastern side of the Site is the Grade II listed Queen's Tower (List UID: 1231643), a tall square shaft dating back to 1887-1893, constructed from Portland stone with red brick bands of four main stages with balustrade balconies between and topped with a copper dome. The tower is designed in the eclectic Renaissance manner and formed part of the original Imperial Institute building designed by Thomas E. Collcott, which was demolished in 1957. The tower was designated in January 1970.
- 1.2.3. The Site is also in proximity to a limited number of other designated heritage assets including; No. 167 Queen's Gate (List UID: 1266000, Grade II* listed), No. 170 Queen's Gate (List UID: 1227415, Grade II* listed), Royal College of Music (List UID: 1265501, Grade II listed), and Nos. 49-58 Princes Gate (List UID: 1066826, Grade II listed). These heritage assets have been assessed to have no inter-visible or historic relationship with the Site and are sufficiently distant from the Site that the proposals will have no impact on their setting or significance. The Site straddles the northern boundary of the Queensgate Conservation Area to the south, which is situated within, and also delineates the boundary of the Royal Borough of Kensington & Chelsea (see **Appendix 1**).
- 1.2.4. The wider setting is characterised by predominantly mid-to-late 19th century planned estates of consistent architectural styles, resulting in formal street patterns interspersed with established trees. There are landscaped, public and private communal squares that provide open relief to the dense built form of the area, complemented by the close proximity of the large open space of Hyde Park to the north.
- 1.2.5. The proposals include the comprehensive landscaping of Queen's Lawn and Imperial College Road to be re-named as Dangoor Plaza. The proposals seek to restrict vehicular access along a section of Imperial College Road and limit vehicular parking within the Site to improve pedestrian flow and interaction in the public space with high quality hard and soft landscaping. The works include a sensitive external architectural lighting scheme and a bespoke statue by Antony Gormley to be situated along Imperial College Road. The existing trees, which make a positive contribution to the setting are to be retained as part of the proposals.

1.3. Planning History

- 1.3.1. There are a number of previous planning applications relating to the Queen's Lawn and Queen's Tower. The full planning history for the Site can be seen in **Appendix 2**.
- 1.3.2. A pre-application meeting was held with the Local Planning Authorities of the Royal Borough of Kensington and Chelsea (Ref: PRE/AR/19 /08107/LEV 3) and the City of Westminster (Ref: P19/01309) on Thursday 20th February. Both Local Authorities agreed that the principle of the landscaping to form Dangoor Plaza was acceptable subject to a muted palette of materials.

2.0 Historic evidence

2.1 Introduction

2.1.1 The following section provides a brief summary of the historical development of the Site and its environs, compiled from sources as listed in the References and drawing on previous studies in the area surrounding the Site.

2.1.2 Understanding the history and context of the relevant heritage assets is important to establish their setting and the contribution that their setting makes to their significance. Historic England guidance on the setting of heritage assets advises that while this matter is primarily a visual assessment, there are other factors, such as historical associations and relationships that define settings and contribute to significance.

2.2 Previous studies

2.2.1 No previous heritage reports have been identified for Queen's Lawn or Queen's Tower.

2.2.2 The Queensgate Conservation Area Proposals Statement was adopted by The Royal Borough of Kensington and Chelsea on 22 May 1989. The purpose of the Proposals Statement is to provide an indication of the Council's likely response to development proposals and to indicate where improvements can be made to the appearance of buildings.

2.3 Historic development of the Site and surrounding area

2.3.1 The present Site occupies land that prior to 1863 had been held as parcels of undeveloped landholdings, creating a hinterland between the encroaching developments from the west and the village settlement of Kensington further west. This is best demonstrated in the 1835 Plan of Westminster No. III Edition (see **Figure 1**), with the location of the Site extending across numerous boundaries of land parcels. This configuration is still evident in the 1851 *Plan of estates in the parishes of Kensington and St Margarets*, as shown in **Figure 2**, land which had been purchased by the Commissioners for the Great Exhibition of 1851. The location of the Site is shown to be within the Gore House Estate at this time, a twenty one and a half acre plot of land that, for the sake of convenience during sale negotiations, took its name from the largest and best known of several houses. The land of Gore House itself only extended to three acres at this time. The Commissioners paid £50,000 for the Gore House Estate in August 1852. Gore

House had been the residence of several notable individuals, including William Wilberforce, but was subsequently demolished in 1857 after being purchased by the Royal Commissioners of the Great Exhibition and was eventually replaced by the Royal Albert Hall.

2.3.2 By 1861, a lease had been granted for thirty one years for the land south of Gore House, which includes the location of the Site, to the Royal Horticultural Society for the creation of gardens that had the support of and some financial backing from Queen Victoria and Prince Albert. The extent of the Horticultural Society Gardens is demonstrated in Edmund Daw's map of 1863 (see **Figure 3**), which begins to show a formalised grid-like arrangement and was described in *The Building News*: 'The Style...is pure Italian-the very Italian of Italy itself...'. Further details of the gardens are illustrated in the Ordnance Survey map of 1867, shown in **Figure 4**. However, by 1866-70 the Society was unable to pay its rent and it was legally liable to forfeit its lease on the garden; by 1876 a scheme was outlined by the Society to surrender its lease. This allowed the Commissioners to pursue their plan to construct a Science Museum across the site of the garden, but this was thwarted by legal complications until the Society were evicted from the gardens following a judgement by the Court of Appeal in 1882. It was not until 1888-1892 that Imperial Institute Road (now Imperial College Road) and Prince Consort Road were laid out across the site of the garden, which had been overlain by new buildings including the Royal College of Science and the Imperial Institute.

2.3.3 The concept of an Imperial Institute had its origins in the 1870s as the notion of an Empire museum, which had garnered the interest of the Prince of Wales (later King Edward VII). In the summer of 1886 the Prince of Wales had initiated the process that led to the founding of the Imperial Institute, with a number of representatives of the British Empire enlisted to perpetuate the success of earlier exhibitions at the Horticultural Society's garden. It was intended that the Institute would commemorate the Golden Jubilee of Queen Victoria, who heartily supported the Prince of Wales when his scheme came up against government resistance, commenting: 'It is curious fact that whenever there is anything of importance wh. I initiate the Gov. always tries to throw cold water on it'. A subscription fund for the project was launched in January 1887 and by September 1894 some £426,100 had been raised against an anticipated total of £500,000. This sum was to pay for a new building and its maintenance, so the prospect of a virtually free site offered by the 1851 Exhibition Commissioners was a compelling reason to favour South Kensington as a preferred location for the Institute. In June 1887, the Commissioners offered a site of 5 $\frac{3}{4}$ acres (later increased to 6 $\frac{3}{4}$ acres), valued at £250,000 on a 999 year lease, for

£5 per annum. The site extended across the former garden of the Royal Horticultural Society and subsequently prevented the Commissioners from developing any significant north-south scenic axis.

2.3.4 In 1887 a building committee was formed and architects were invited to submit their names for the task of designing the Institute. Of the 66 that submitted their names, only six were chosen and they were each paid £200 to submit designs within three months. The building cost was to be limited to £250,000, to include a 'fine reception hall', a library as well as reading rooms, laboratories, conference rooms and committee rooms amongst a number of the directives that *The British Architect's* correspondent described as hardly being 'cruelly vague'. The committee approved the designs of Thomas Edward Colcutt in June 1887, although they made it known that the designs would require modification. The critics also approved of Colcutt's design and the opportunities for vistas that it afforded, acknowledging it as 'a simple and well-digested scheme, easily read and conveniently contrived'. The proposed principal floor, as shown in **Figure 5**, demonstrates Colcutt's clever use of alternating solids and voids that gave the 'modest' building a sense of a grander scale.

2.3.5 The foundation stone of the Institute was laid by Queen Victoria in July of 1887, with the foundations completed by May of 1888. By 1892 the central tower (now known as the Queen's Tower) was approaching its full height of 287 feet, and in June of that year the building was informally opened. The official opening of the Institute by Queen Victoria took place on 10 May 1893; she described the event as 'a really momentous day, like a small Jubilee'. The initial built form of the Institute can be seen in the Ordnance Survey map of 1896 (see **Figure 6**), as well as in early photographs and sketches of the finished building which demonstrate its striking effect, as shown in **Plates 2 , 3 and 4**. The final cost of the building was said to be £354,000 (in excess of £44 million at 2019 values), with some thinking too much had been spent on the building. The desperate financial position of the Institute meant that half of the building was given to the University of London in 1899, as the university had left its previous location at Burlington Gardens earlier that year. By 1901 the whole of the building had been surrendered by the Institute to the Government, which then sub-leased part of the building back to the Institute. It transpired at about the same time that the work of the Institute was duplicating that of the Government's Board of Trade and the Governing Body decided to wholly transfer the Institute to the Government. Under an Act of 1902 the Institute was placed under the Board of Trade.

2.3.6 The work of the Institute during the earlier years of its administration under central Government proved invaluable, and it appears that alterations and additions were made to the plan form of the Institute as

illustrated in the Ordnance Survey map of 1916 (see **Figure 7**). By 1925 the management of the Institute was transferred to the Department of Overseas Trade (under the Board of Trade). It was felt by the 1920s that the exhibition galleries of the Institute should be closed, having become 'desolate and deserted', however they were ultimately retained, as demonstrated in the Ordnance Survey map of 1949-51 (see **Figure 8**). This map demonstrates the cluttered built form that began to encroach upon the rear of the former gardens around this time, including a generating station put up by the Office of Works in the north-west quadrangle in 1905-06.

2.3.7 In 1949 the Institute was transferred to the Ministry of Education following the cessation of the Department of Overseas Trade in the same year. By the 1950s, and after half a century of tenure of 'outsiders' to the building, the interiors of Colcutt's building had acquired a depressing and purposeless atmosphere. It was in 1953 that the Government announced its intention to expand Imperial College, and by 1956 the architect's plan was made public, causing agitation when it became apparent that this would require significant demolition. There was strong public opposition to the demolition, unusually so for a building of a style and period that was not particularly in fashion. It was decided by the Government that the tower (Queen's Tower) alone would be kept, although The Royal Fine Arts Commission were unconvinced that the entire building could not have been retained. In 1957 demolition of the rear galleries was begun, by 1962 a College building had already replaced the east wing of the main range and by 1965 the west wing had also been demolished, as demonstrated in the Ordnance Survey map of 1965-1968 (see **Figure 9**). By 1958 the Imperial Institute had been renamed the Commonwealth Institute, having shifted towards a substantially different role focused on educational and interpretive work within a new building at Holland Park.

2.3.8 Between 1966 and 1968 works were undertaken to make the central tower (Queen's Tower) of the former Imperial Institute freestanding, whilst the remainder of the Institute was totally demolished by 1967. The expansion of Imperial College also saw the demolition of the nearby City and Guilds College building in 1962-63, which is still identified on the 1968 Ordnance Survey map (see **Figure 10**). The Imperial College complex, which had been opened by Queen Elizabeth II in 1965, is fully evident, with the freestanding Queen's Tower standing at the eastern edge of a semi-enclosed square in the 1991 Ordnance Survey map, as shown in **Figure 11**.

2.3.9 Following a site visit to Queen's Lawn on Wednesday 24th July 2019, it is evident that alterations have been made to the built form of the buildings that partially enclose the lawn and Queen's Tower, which

has remained unaltered since the mid-20th century works to make it freestanding. The public realm is characterised by established trees lining Imperial College Road, which also delineate the southern edge of Queen's Lawn, a simple expanse of grass with non-descript street furniture and incoherent lighting scattered around the edges. Vehicular parking creates visual clutter along the edges of Imperial College Road, which is accessed from Exhibition Road to the east or Queen's Gate to the west.

3.0 Designated heritage assets – significance and setting

3.1 Introduction

- 3.1.1 A heritage asset may be defined as a building, monument, site, place, area or landscape positively identified as having a degree of significance meriting consideration in planning decisions, because of its heritage interest. Heritage assets include designated heritage assets and assets identified by the local planning authority (including local listing).
- 3.1.2 The planning policies listed in **Appendix 3** aim to promote development proposals that will preserve, conserve and, where possible and appropriate, enhance the historic environment; and that will seek to avoid or mitigate against harm.
- 3.1.3 The heritage assets that are relevant to this report are the Grade II Listed Queen's Tower (List UID: 1231643) and the Queensgate Conservation Area.

3.2 Significance

- 3.2.1 Historic England suggest that the aspects that reflect significance are the four values that people associate to a place: aesthetic value, evidential value, historic value and communal value. However, the NPPF defines the significance of a heritage asset as *"The value of a heritage asset to this and future generations because of its heritage interest. That interest may be archaeological, architectural, artistic or historic. Significance derives not only from a heritage asset's physical presence, but also from its setting."* The NPPF definition largely corroborates the four values identified by Historic England in the *English Heritage Conservation Principles Policies and Guidance 2008*, although the Historic England Guidance takes a broader approach.

3.3 Significance of the Queen's Tower (Grade II listed)

- 3.3.1 The Queen's Tower is the last surviving element of the original Imperial Institute building designed by Thomas E. Colcutt and constructed between 1887-1893 in the eclectic Renaissance manner. The tower is built of Portland Stone with brick bands and topped with a copper dome. Alterations were made in the 1960s to stabilise the tower as a freestanding structure, following the demolition of the main body of the Imperial Institute building. The property was Grade II Listed on 14th January 1970. In *The Buildings of England: London 3: North West*, Pevsner describes the setting of the Queen's Tower:

'To the s the hard urban mood is tempered by two lawns, the larger one providing the setting for the TOWER, incongruously flamboyant in isolation from the rest of Colcutt's demolished Imperial Institute'

Aesthetic Value

- 3.3.2 The Queen's Tower is of high quality design and material treatment in the eclectic Renaissance style, a reflection of its significance as a striking element of the former Imperial Institute building. The tower is well maintained and makes a positive contribution to its immediate and wider setting. The base of the tower was altered in the 1960s with the addition of a plinth and steps, as evidenced in the 1968 Ordnance Survey map, to allow the tower to remain freestanding; these works have not adversely affected its aesthetic value, which is deemed to be **high**.

Evidential Value

- 3.3.3 As the last remaining element of the imposing Imperial Institute building, the tower provides an important insight into the development of the Site and the architectural proclivities of institutional buildings. The alteration of the tower at lower levels to allow for the structure to be freestanding has affected its historic plan form, and its isolation following the demolition of the Imperial Institute has eroded its context. The Queen's Lawn offers some scope for below-ground archaeology related to the former western range of the main building of the Imperial Institute which was demolished in the late 1950s, although this would presumably be limited to foundation works. The evidential value of the heritage asset has been assessed to be **high**.

Historical Value

- 3.3.4 The historical value of the Queen's Tower is in its association with the former Imperial Institute building and its architect, Thomas E. Colcutt. The overall Site has historical links with the earlier tenure of the Royal Horticultural Society and the wider development of this part of Kensington from the early-19th century. The historical value of the heritage asset has been assessed to be **high**.

Communal Value

- 3.3.5 It has been assessed that the external aesthetic of the Grade II Listed Queen's Tower can be appreciated by a broad audience within the open realm of Queen's Lawn. However, access to the tower is limited, and as such the heritage asset is deemed to have a **moderate** communal value.

Setting

- 3.3.6 The setting of Queen's Tower is characterised by mid-20th century development, predominantly of concrete construction and of no significant architectural merit. Those buildings that semi-enclose the tower, although well-maintained, are judged to make no contribution to the setting or significance of the heritage asset. The green features within the immediate setting, including the Queen's Lawn and the rows of established trees along Imperial College Road, assist in softening the harsh concrete exteriors of the surrounding buildings. These landscaping features are assessed to make a positive contribution to the setting and significance of the Grade II listed tower.

3.4 Significance of the Queensgate Conservation Area

- 3.4.1 The Queensgate (also referred to as Queen's Gate) Conservation Area was first designated in 1969, with the boundary extended in 1972 and again in 1976 and 1989. The present layout of the conservation area is owed largely to the Great Exhibition of 1851 and extends as far north as Kensington Road and to Brompton Road in the south. The conservation area extends east along Imperial College Road, incorporating a limited area of the Site, but does not include the designated heritage asset of Queen's Tower. The Queensgate Conservation Area abuts a number of other conservations areas within The Royal Borough of Kensington and Chelsea. The Queen's Gate Conservation Area Proposals Statement was adopted by the Local Authority on the 22nd May 1989.

Aesthetic Value

- 3.4.2 The aesthetic of the conservation area is dominated by large townhouses, predominantly in the west of the conservation area, with the grand scale museum buildings of high quality design and material treatment in the east; these dominate much of the street scene of Exhibition and Cromwell Roads. Overall, the quality of built development in the conservation area is high. However, the Proposals Statement identifies a number of incongruous elements resulting from later redevelopment and alterations (e.g. roof extensions and unsympathetic commercial signage) that have a negative effect on the significance of the conservation area. A number of the historic buildings have undergone alterations, particularly subdivision of the townhouses, which have for the most part been successful in accommodating new uses and ensuring their long-term conservation. The landscaped garden squares and established tree-lined streets provide a relief in the dense built form of the area and make a positive contribution to the overall setting of the conservation area. The aesthetic value of the conservation area

is judged to be **high**.

Evidential Value

- 3.4.3 The built form of the conservation area provides a clear narrative of its development and evolution, with 19th century townhouses juxtaposed against smaller scale properties and a combination of mews buildings and earlier built form, as well as the grander-scale of the South Kensington museum quarter. Prior to the Great Exhibition of 1851 there was almost no development in the area, except in the extreme north and south. The Site is not identified as being within an Archaeology Priority Area. The overall evidential value of the conservation area is judged to be **medium**.

Historical Value

- 3.4.4 The historical value of the Queensgate Conservation Area is derived from its wider association with the development and growth of London and some of the prominent inhabitants and visitors it has accommodated. As such, the historical value of the conservation area is assessed to be **high**.

Communal Value

- 3.4.5 The conservation area includes a number of public communal spaces and commercial streets that allow for full public enjoyment and engagement. A number of the buildings are of an institutional nature, with places of public worship, museums and employment that also provide public interaction, and as such the communal value for the Queensgate Conservation Area is **high**.

Setting

- 3.4.6 The Queensgate Conservation Area makes a positive contribution to the overall townscape of the capital and has retained much of its historical and aesthetic interest, from which it derives significance. However, the fabric of the conservation area has been undermined by some incongruous late-20th century developments and alterations that do not sympathetically respond to the aesthetic or material palette of the area.
- 3.4.7 The Queensgate Conservation Area is bounded by the neighbouring Brompton Conservation Area to the east, Thurloe & Smith's Charity Conservation Area to the south and Cornwall Conservation Area and Courtfield Conservation Areas to the west. All of these conservation areas are predominantly

residential in nature and well maintained, making a positive contribution to the setting of the Queensgate Conservation Area.

- 3.4.8 The majority of the Site sits outside of the Queensgate Conservation Area to the north, and it is judged that the Grade II listed Queen's Tower, adjacent lawn and tree-lined street make a positive contribution to the setting of the conservation area. However, the mid-20th century concrete buildings of Imperial College, although well maintained, only make a neutral contribution to the setting of the conservation area, as they are mostly obscured by intervening built form and established trees.

4.0 Impacts

4.1 Introduction

- 4.1.1 The management and mitigation of change to the heritage resource resulting from development is based on the recognition within Government planning objectives that “ *These {heritage} assets are an irreplaceable resource...*” (NPPF para. 184). Impacts to the historic environment and its associated heritage assets arise where changes are made to their physical environment by means of the loss and/or degradation of their physical fabric or setting, which in turn leads to a reduction in the significance of the historic environment record and its associated heritage assets.
- 4.1.2 The following section outlines the proposed development and analyses whether it would affect the significance of the designated heritage assets.

4.2 Proposed works

- 4.2.1 Following the pre-application meeting on the 20th February 2020 the proposed works have been adjusted to take on some of the comments made by the LPAs. The works comprise landscaping works to the existing Queen's Lawn and part of Imperial College Road, where it is also proposed to restrict vehicular traffic access through controlled measures and to limit vehicular parking. A sympathetic external architectural lighting scheme is to be installed that highlights the green landscape elements and Grade II listed Queen's Tower.
- 4.2.2 This report accompanies design drawings by Penwarden Hale Architects that should be consulted in conjunction with the following section.
- 4.2.3 The proposed changes, their impacts and their effect on significance are assessed below:

4.3 Impact on the Queen's Tower (Grade II listed)

- 4.3.1 The proposed works include engraving the non-original steps of the Queen's Tower; this work will have a negligible impact on the Grade II listed heritage asset. The landscaping in the immediate vicinity of the heritage asset will enhance its setting by creating a more cohesive and accessible public realm that will further improve the appreciation and understanding of the tower. The lawn is to be retained to the west of the tower and extended slightly to the south, with the replacement hardstanding landscaping to

be of a sympathetic design and muted grey material palette that responds to the area, with particular reference to Exhibition Road.

4.3.2 The restriction of vehicular traffic and strict limiting of parking immediately south of the lawn will further enhance the setting of the heritage asset and allow for increased appreciation of the Grade II listed tower.

4.3.3 A sensitive fully inset architectural lighting scheme, which illuminates the landscaping and Grade II listed heritage asset, is judged to have a positive effect on the setting and significance by allowing them to be appreciated beyond daylight hours. A lighting scheme that illuminates the aesthetic qualities of the Queen's Tower will better reveal its significance, and the illumination of trees and landscaping will further enhance the setting of the heritage asset.

4.4 **Impact on the Queensgate Conservation Area**

4.4.1 The proposals to undertake landscaping works to the existing Queen's Lawn and a section of Imperial College Road that falls within the Queensgate Conservation Area will create a cohesive aesthetic using a high quality material palette that sensitively responds to the heritage asset. The existing trees that line Imperial College Road and the grass lawn to the west of Queen's Tower will be retained and enhanced through a sensitive architectural lighting scheme, which is judged to have a positive effect on the setting of the conservation area.

4.4.2 The proposals to restrict vehicular traffic access and limit vehicular parking within the Site will improve pedestrian mobility around the Site and enhance the appreciation of the conservation area. This proposal also removes the associated vehicular clutter that otherwise detracts from the positive elements of the conservation area.

4.4.3 Overall, the proposals are deemed to have no adverse effects on the significance of the conservation area and indeed the improved design, access and interpretation of the public space will enhance the setting of the conservation area.

5.0 Conclusion

- 5.1.1 Savills Heritage Planning was commissioned by Imperial College London to produce a Heritage Statement to identify and assess those heritage assets that may be affected by the proposed works to the existing Queen's Lawn and a section of Imperial College Road. This assessment is to accompany an application for full planning and listed building consent.
- 5.1.2 The historic significance of the Grade II listed Queen's Tower, as identified in this Heritage Statement, has been deemed to be high for its aesthetic and historic interest. Although the heritage asset has undergone alterations to its base and lower levels in the mid-20th century to make the structure freestanding, these works are not judged to have diminished the significance of the Grade II listed tower. The proposed works for the landscaping of the Queen's Lawn and a section of Imperial College Road will have no material impact on the heritage asset and have been assessed to enhance the setting of the heritage asset by allowing for an increased appreciation of the tower. The proposed material palette is sympathetic to that in the wider area and will have no adverse effects on the Grade II listed tower. The engraving of the non-original base steps to the tower will have a no adverse effect on the heritage asset and will allow for further recognition of the contributors to the work and enhancement of Imperial College. The external architectural lighting scheme will further enhance the designated heritage asset and its setting by allowing it to be appreciated for greater periods of time and is assessed to have a positive effect.
- 5.1.3 The significance of the Queensgate Conservation area has been assessed to derive from its high quality architecture and layout resulting from a history of planned development from the mid-19th century, including the construction of the South Kensington museum quarter. Late-20th and early-21st century developments have had varying success in their contribution to the significance of the conservation area. The proposed works for landscaping the existing Queen's Lawn and Imperial College Road seek to adopt a material palette that is sympathetic to the wider conservation area and will create a cohesive aesthetic that will have no adverse effects on the setting or significance of the conservation area. The installation of external architectural lighting will enhance the positive features within and in the setting of the conservation area, namely the established trees and is assessed to have a positive effect. Overall, the proposals are deemed to preserve the special interest and aesthetic of the Queensgate Conservation Area.

- 5.1.4 This Heritage Statement meets the requirements of the NPPF and provides sufficient information in regards to heritage considerations relating to proposed, as detailed above.

6.0 References

- 'Estates and houses before 1851: The Gore House Estate', in *Survey of London: Volume 38, South Kensington Museums Area*, ed. F H W Sheppard (London, 1975), pp. 11-13. *British History Online* <http://www.british-history.ac.uk/survey-london/vol38/pp11-13> [accessed 5 August 2019].
- Exploring London, *Lost London – The Imperial Institute*. 24 Feb 2018. Online [accessed 05 Aug 2019]. <https://exploring-london.com/2018/02/24/lost-london-the-imperial-institute/>
- 'Garden of the Royal Horticultural Society', in *Survey of London: Volume 38, South Kensington Museums Area*, ed. F H W Sheppard (London, 1975), pp. 124-132. *British History Online* <http://www.british-history.ac.uk/survey-london/vol38/pp124-132> [accessed 5 August 2019].
 - Historic England, A Guide for Owners of Listed Buildings
 - Historic England 2015, *Making Changes to Heritage Assets*, Historic England Advice Note 2
- 'Imperial Institute', in *Survey of London: Volume 38, South Kensington Museums Area*, ed. F H W Sheppard (London, 1975), pp. 220-227. *British History Online* <http://www.british-history.ac.uk/survey-london/vol38/pp220-227> [accessed 5 August 2019].
- National Planning Policy Framework; Conserving and enhancing the historic environment, DCLG: 2018
- Principles of Selection for Listing Buildings, DCMS: 2010

8.0 Appendix 2: Planning history

Planning Reference	Description	Decision	Date
09/05328/FULL	Safety works to existing staircase, hatches and trap doors; repairs to existing internal construction, particularly to stairs and general upgrading of interior	Application Deemed Refused	2009
09/05329/LBC	As above	Application Deemed Refused	2009
07/04741/ADFULL	Landscaping scheme for the planting bed pursuant to Condition 1 of planning permission dated 30 October 2006 (RN: 06/06253/FULL)	Permitted	16 Jul 2007
07/01050/ADFULL	Details of landscaping scheme pursuant to Condition 1 of planning permission dated 30 Oct 2006 (RN: 06/06253/FULL)	Refused	08 Mar 2007
06/06253/FULL	Installation of access ramp to the Queen's Lawn to facilitate disabled access to Imperial College	Permitted	30 Oct 2006
06/04632/FULL	Erection of temporary office buildings for decant of South Kensington based staff for duration of a two year refurbishment programme (Resubmission)	Permitted	17 Aug 2006
06/02104/FULL	Erection of a three storey temporary building on Queen's Lawn and two storey temporary building on the adjacent car park to be used as offices for a period of two years during the refurbishment of Imperial College	Withdrawn	18 May 2006
96/09100/FULL	Alterations to improve weather resistance & ventilation incl. coating asphalt roofs with plastic coating, renewing windows with aluminium casements & timber louvred screens Queens Tower	Permitted	10 Dec 1996
96/07345/LBC	As above	Permitted	05 Aug 1997

9.0 Appendix 3: Planning policy and guidance

9.1 Legislation.

9.1.1 Legislation relating to listed buildings and conservation areas is contained within the Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act 1990.

9.1.2 The Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act 1990 provides that with regard to applications for planning permission affecting listed buildings or its setting:

“s.66(1) In considering whether to grant planning permission for development which affects a listed building or its setting, the local planning authority or, as the case may be, the Secretary of State shall have special regard to the desirability of preserving the building or its setting or any features of special architectural or historic interest which it possesses.”

9.1.3 The Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act 1990 sets out that with regard to application for planning permission within conservation areas:

“s.72(1) In the exercise, with respect to any buildings or other land in a conservation area, of any powers under any of the provisions mentioned in subsection (2), special attention shall be paid to the desirability of preserving or enhancing the character or appearance of that area.”

9.2 National Planning Policy Framework

9.2.1 The National Planning Policy Framework was introduced in March 2012, and later amended on the 28th July 2018 and further amendments in February 2019, as the full statement of Government planning policies covering all aspects of the planning process. One of the key planning principles of the Framework states that heritage assets are:

“an irreplaceable resource, and should be conserved in a manner appropriate to their significance, so that they can be enjoyed for their contribution to the quality of life of existing and future generations” (paragraph 184)

9.2.2 The glossary of the Framework (Annex 2) defines conservation as the process of maintaining and managing change to a heritage asset in a way that sustains and, where appropriate, enhances its significance.

- 9.2.3 Chapter 16 of the Framework outlines the Government's guidance regarding conserving and enhancing the historic environment in more detail. Paragraph 189 requires the significance of the heritage assets, which may be affected by the proposals to be described as part of any submission, ideally as part of a Heritage Statement report. The level of detail should be proportionate to the importance of the assets and sufficient to understand the potential impact of the proposals on their significance.
- 9.2.4 Paragraph 190 sets out that local planning authorities should also identify and assess the particular significance of heritage assets that may be affected by development proposals. They should take this assessment into account when considering the impact of development proposals in order to avoid or minimise conflict between the heritage asset's conservation and any aspect of such development proposals.
- 9.2.5 Paragraph 192 states that local planning authorities should take account of the desirability of sustaining and enhancing the significance of all heritage assets and putting them into viable uses consistent with their conservation, the positive contribution that conservation of heritage assets can make to sustainable communities including their economic vitality, and the desirability of new development making a positive contribution to local character and distinctiveness.
- 9.2.6 Paragraphs 193 and 194 further outlines that local planning authorities should give great weight to the asset's conservation when considering the impact of a proposed development on the significance of a designated heritage asset, such as the conservation area. The more important the heritage asset, the greater the weight should be. It is also specified that any harm to or loss of, significance of a designated heritage asset should require clear and convincing justification.
- 9.2.7 Paragraph 195 outlines that local planning authorities should refuse consent where a development proposal will lead to substantial harm or total loss of significance, unless it can be demonstrated that this is necessary to deliver substantial public benefits that outweigh such harm or loss, or a number of other tests can be satisfied. Paragraph 196 concerns development proposals that will lead to less than substantial harm to the significance of a designated heritage asset. Here harm should be weighed against the public benefits, including securing the optimum viable use.
- 9.2.8 Paragraph 199 states that Local Authorities should require developers to record and advance the understanding of the significance of any heritage assets to be lost (wholly or in part) in a manner

proportionate to their importance and the impact. This evidence (and any archive generated) is to be made publicly accessible. However, the recording of evidence of our past should not be a factor in deciding whether such loss should be permitted.

9.2.9 Paragraph 200 encourages local planning authorities to look for opportunities for new development within conservation areas and within the setting of heritage assets, to enhance or better reveal their significance. It also states that development proposals that preserve those elements of the setting that make a positive contribution to or better reveal the significance of a heritage asset, should be treated favourably.

9.2.10 Paragraph 201 establishes that not all elements of a conservation area will necessarily contribute to its significance. Loss of a building which makes a positive contribution to the significance of the conservation area should be treated as either substantial harm under paragraph 195 or less than substantial under paragraph 196, as appropriate taking into account the relative significance of the building affected and its contribution to the significance of the conservation area as a whole.

9.3 **Local Planning Policy Context**

9.3.1 The Site is located across the boundaries of the London Boroughs of Westminster and The Royal Borough of Kensington and Chelsea (TRBKC), which are two of 32 London boroughs. As such, local planning policy is covered by both the London Plan administered by the London Assembly, and Westminster City Council's Development Plan comprising the City Plan (2016), the saved policies of the Unitary Development Plan (2007) and the Local Plan of TRBKC.

The London Local Plan (2011): The Spatial Development Strategy for London consolidated with alterations since 2011 (March 2016)

9.3.2 The London Plan 2011 (incorporating minor alterations from October 2013 and 2015) is the spatial development strategy for Greater London and as such a piece of relevant planning policy.

9.3.3 **London Plan Policy 7.4** discusses the local character of buildings, streets and open spaces and notes that development should have regard to the pattern and grain of development, allow positively contributing buildings to influence future character and is informed by the historic environment.

9.3.4 **London Plan Policy 7.6** relates to architecture and requires buildings to be of the highest architectural

quality and of a scale, composition and proportion which enhances the public realm. The policy notes that materials and details should complement the established local character and that the amenity of surrounding areas should not be unacceptably harmed by new development.

9.3.5 **London Plan Policy 7.8** indicates that development should be sympathetic to the form, scale, materials and architectural details of heritage assets, and should, where appropriate conserve, restore and re-use heritage assets. The policy requires historic environments such as conservation areas to be preserved and enhanced and development affecting heritage assets and their settings to conserve their significance in a sympathetic manner.

9.3.6 **London Plan Policy 7.9** requires the significance of a heritage asset to be assessed when development is proposed and schemes designed so that the heritage significance is recognised and, where possible, repaired, restored and put to a suitable and viable use that is consistent with their conservation.

Westminster City Plan 2016

9.3.7 **Policy S25 Heritage** – Recognising Westminster's wider historic environment, its extensive heritage assets will be conserved, including its listed buildings, conservation areas, Westminster's World Heritage Site, its historic parks including five Royal Parks, squares, gardens and other open space, their settings, and its archaeological heritage. Historic and other important buildings should be upgraded sensitively, to improve their environment performance and make them easily accessible.

9.3.8 **Policy S28 Design** – Development must incorporate exemplary standards of sustainable and inclusive urban design and architecture. In the correct context, imaginative modern architecture is encouraged provided that it respects Westminster's heritage and local distinctiveness and enriches its world-class city environment.

Westminster Unitary Development Plan saved policies (2007)

9.3.9 **Policy DES 1 Principles of urban design and conservation** - To ensure the highest quality in the form and quality of new development in order to preserve or enhance the townscape of Westminster; to provide adequate access; to reduce crime and improve security.

9.3.10 **Policy DES 5 and 6** - This makes sure that alterations and extensions in all parts of the City are of a high standard of design.

9.3.11 **Policy DES 9 Conservation Areas** – This preserves and enhances the character and appearance of conservation areas and their settings.

9.3.12 **Policy DES 10 Listed Buildings** – To protect and enhance listed buildings, their settings and those features of special architectural or historic interest that they possess.

TRBK&C Policy

9.3.13 The Local Plan sets out the vision, objectives and detailed spatial strategy for future development in TRBK&C up to 2028. Relevant policies are as follows:

9.3.14 **Policy C1 Context and Character** – *‘The council will require all developments to respect the existing context, character and appearance, taking opportunities available to improve the quality and character of buildings and the area and the way it functions, including being inclusive for all’.* To deliver this TRBK&C will:

- a) Require development to contribute positively to the townscape through the architecture and urban form, addressing matters such as scale, height, bulk, mass, proportion, plot width, building lines, street form, rhythm, roofscape, materials and historic fabric as well as vistas, views, gaps and open space;
- h) Ensure that, in carrying out alterations and extensions, the characteristics of the type of building, such as mews, terrace or mansion block, is preserved and enhanced.

9.3.15 **Policy CL 2 Design Quality** – *‘The council will require all development to be of the highest architectural and urban design quality, taking opportunities to improve the quality and character of buildings and the area and the way it functions.’* To deliver this TRBK&C will:

- a) Require development to be:
 - i. functional – fit for purpose and legible;
 - ii. robust – well built, remain in good condition and adaptable to changes of use, lifestyle, demography and climate;
 - iii. attractive; and,
 - iv. locally distinctive.
- b) Require an appropriate architectural style on a site-by-site basis, in response to:

- i. the context of the site;
- ii. the building's proposed design, form and use; and,
- iii. whether the townscape is of uniform or varied character.

9.3.16 **Policy CL 3 Heritage Assets: Conservation Areas and Historic Spaces** - *'The Council will require development to preserve and take opportunities to enhance the cherished and familiar local scene.'* To deliver this TRBK&C will:

- a) require development to preserve or enhance the character or appearance of the conservation area and protect the special architectural or historic interest of the area and its setting;
- b) resist substantial demolition in conservation areas unless it can be demonstrated that:
 - i. the building or part of the building or structure makes no positive contribution to the character and appearance of the area:

9.3.17 Supporting paragraph 34.3.30 states: *'When development takes place to listed buildings, it is appropriate to take opportunities to reinstate missing features which are considered important to their special interest or to remove additions or modifications that harm the significance of the building.'*

9.3.18 **Policy CL 4 Heritage Assets: Listed Buildings, Scheduled Ancient Monuments and Archaeology:** *'The Council will require development to protect the heritage significance of listed buildings, scheduled ancient monuments and sites of archaeological interest.'* To deliver this TRBK&C will:

- a) require all development and any works for alterations or extensions related to listed buildings... to preserve the heritage significance of the building... or their setting or any features of special architectural or historic interest;
- b) resist the demolition of listed buildings in whole or in part, or the removal of modifications or features of architectural importance, both internal and external;
- c) require the preservation of original architectural features, and later features of interest, both internal and external;
- d) take opportunities to:
 - i. reinstate internal and external features of special architectural or historic significance, commensurate with the extent of proposed development; and,
 - ii. take opportunities to remove internal and external features that harm the

architectural or historic significance of the asset, commensurate with the extent of proposed development;

- e) resist the change of use of a listed building that would materially harm its character; and,
- f) require any work to a listed building to sustain the significance of the heritage asset and as such strongly encourage any works to a listed building to be carried out in a correct, scholarly manner by appropriate specialists.

9.3.19 Policy CL 9 Existing Buildings – Extensions and Modifications; *‘The Council will require extensions and modifications to existing buildings to be subordinate to the original building, to allow the form of the original building to be clearly understood, and to reinforce the character and integrity of the original building, or group of buildings.’* To deliver this TRBK&C will resist proposals for extensions if:

- a) the extension would extend rearward beyond the existing general rear building line of any neighbouring extensions;
- b) the extension would rise above the general height of neighbouring and nearby extensions, or rise to or above the original main eaves of parapet;
- c) the extension would spoil or disrupt the even rhythm of rear additions;
- d) the detailed design of the addition, including the location or proportions or dimensions of fenestration or the external materials and finishes, would not be in character with the existing building;
- e) the extension would breach the established front building line;
- f) an important or historic gap or view would be blocked or diminished;
- g) the architectural symmetry of a building, terrace or group of building would be impaired;
- h) the original architectural features on a formal flank elevation would be obscured;
- i) access to the rear of the property of those adjoining would be lost;
- j) a conservatory is proposed to be at roof level above garden level or on a corner site.

9.3.20 Policy CL 11 Views – *‘The council will require all development to protect and enhance views, vistas, gaps and the skyline that contribute to the character of an area.’* To deliver this TRBK&C will:

- a) resist development which interrupts, disrupts or detracts from strategic and local vistas, views and gaps and the skyline;

- b) require development whose visual impacts extend beyond that of the immediate street to demonstrate how views are protected or enhanced;
- c) require, within conservation areas, development to preserve or enhance views:
 - i. identified in conservation area appraisals;
 - ii. generally within, into, and out of conservation areas, including the rear of properties;
 - iii. that affect the setting of and from development on sited adjacent to conservation areas and listed buildings.
- d) require development to respect the setting of a landmark, taking care not to create intrusive elements in its foreground, middle ground or background.

10.0 Appendix 4: Maps and images

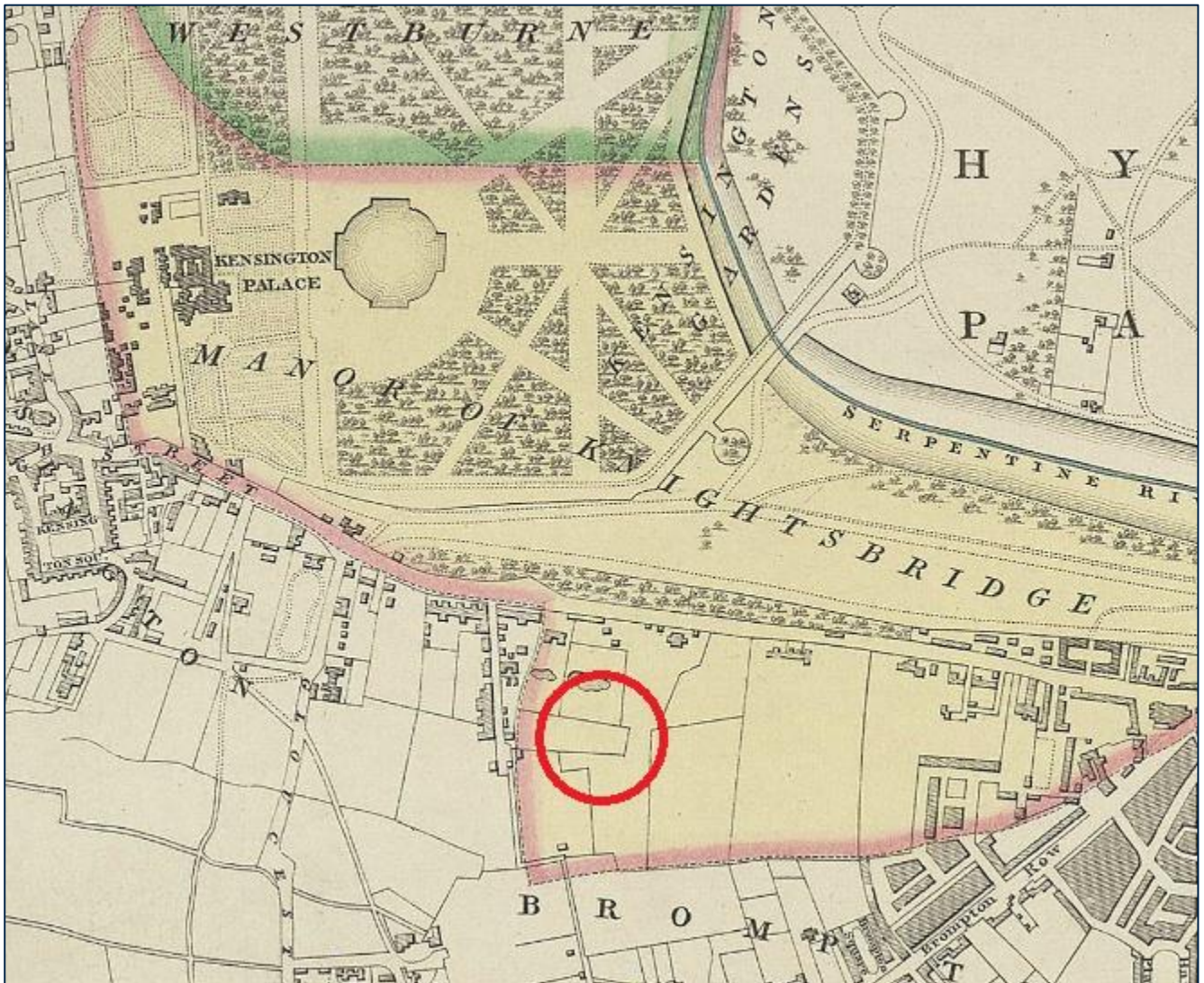
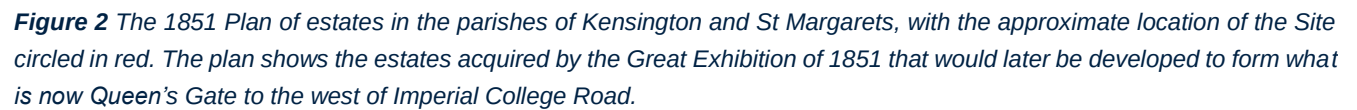


Figure 1 The 1835 Plan of Westminster No. III with the approximate location of the Site circled in red, situated within the rural setting of Kensington at this time. To the north was Gore House, whose estate only extended to 3 acres but conveniently lent its name to the twenty one and a half acres acquired by Commissioners of the Great Exhibition 1851. The boundary of the borough of Westminster is indicated by the light red outline.



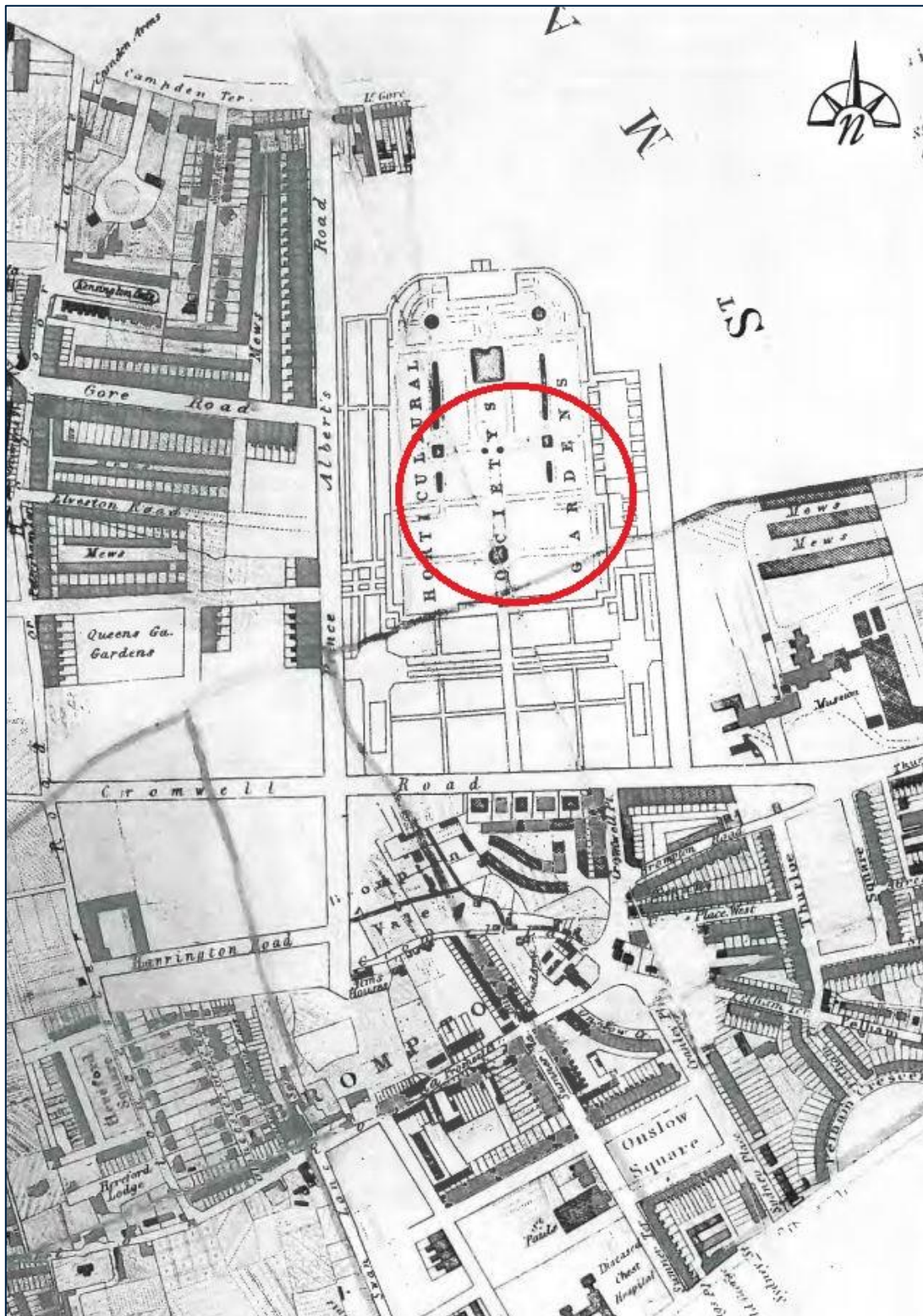


Figure 3 Edmund Daw's map of 1863 with the approximate location of the Site circled in red over what had become the Horticultural Society Gardens, which existed until 1882. The overall site would be developed to include the Natural History Museum and other institutions.

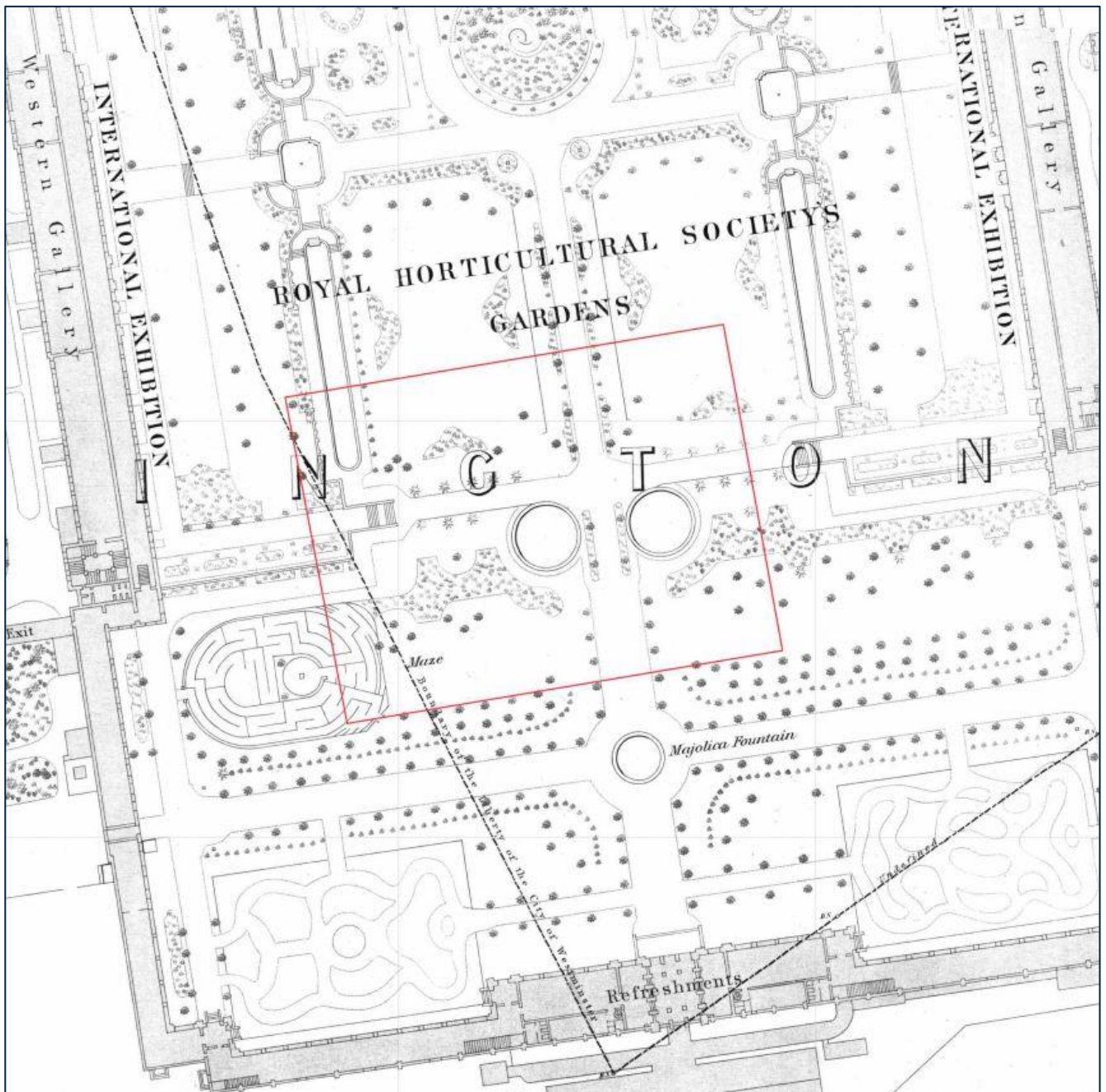


Figure 4 The 1867 Ordnance Survey showing the Royal Horticultural Society's Gardens in greater details. The outline of the Site, shown here in red, occupies a section of the former gardens, which existed until 1882. © Groundsure. 2019.

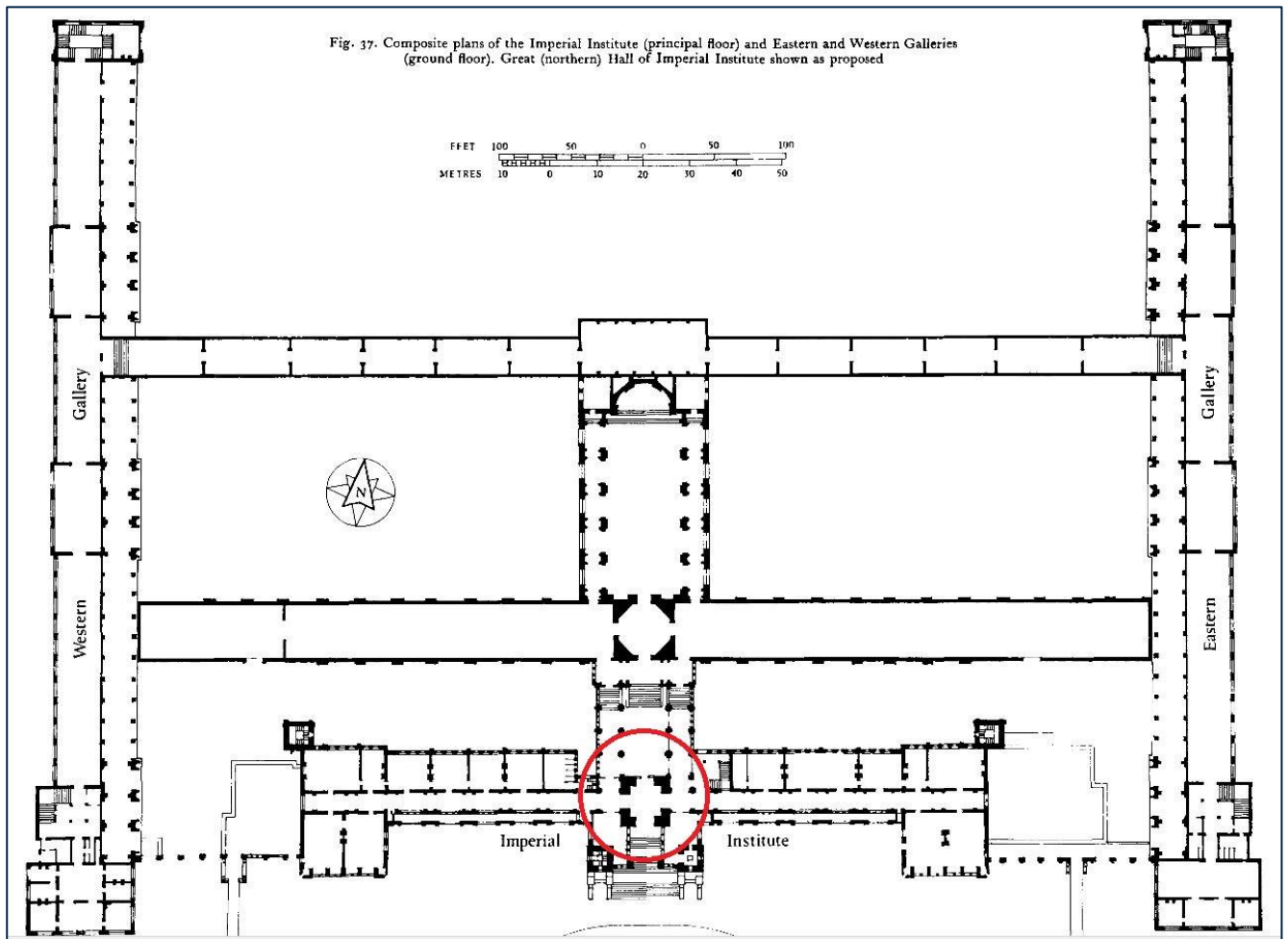


Figure 5 The approved plan of the principal floor of the Imperial Institute designed by Thomas E. Colcutt and constructed 1887-1893. The Queen's Tower is circled in red and is the last remaining feature of the neo-Renaissance style building.

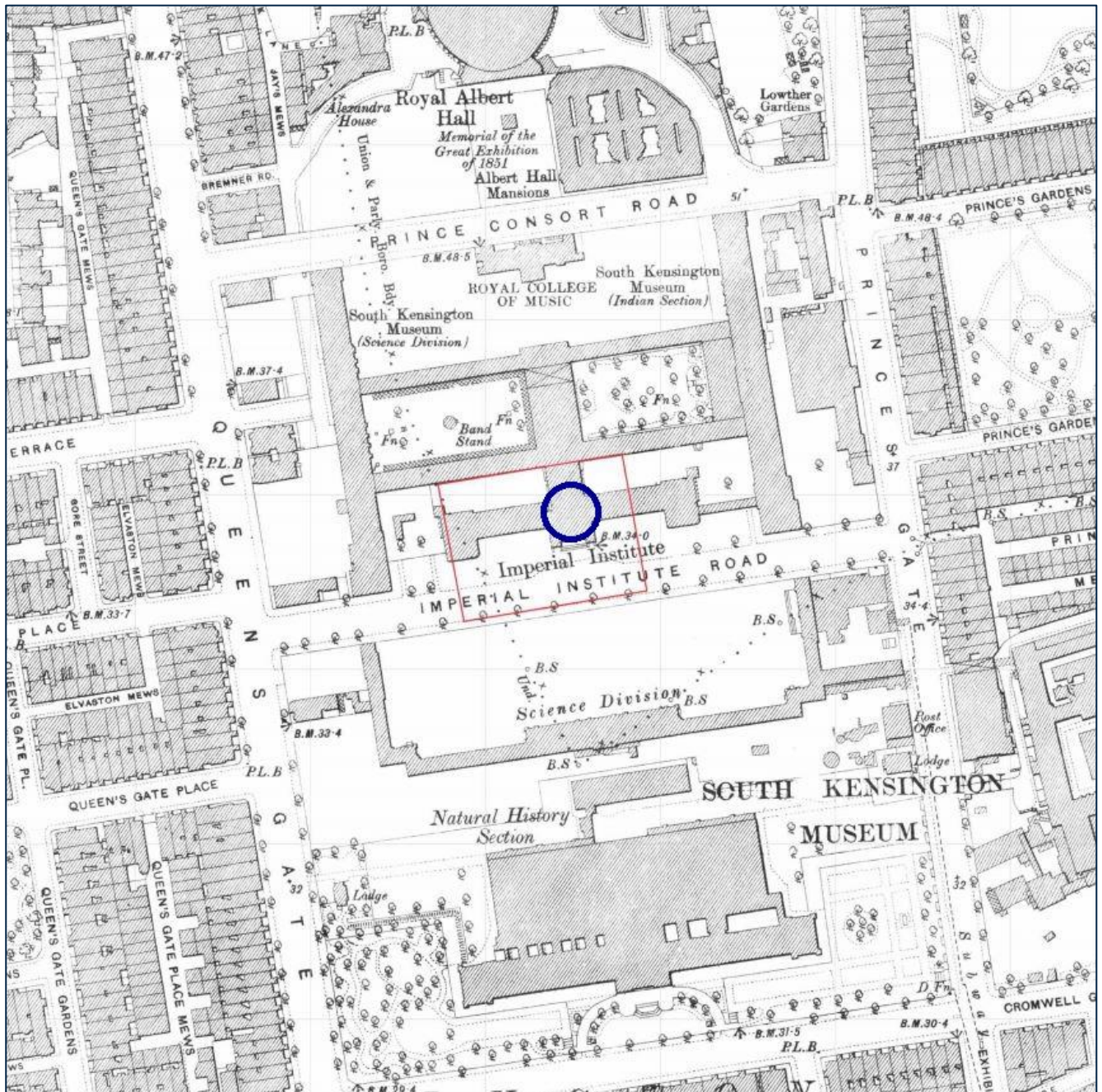


Figure 6 The 1896 Ordnance Survey showing the completed Imperial Institute building. The location of the Site is outlined in red, whilst the location of the Grade II listed Queen's Tower is circled here in blue. The Institute faced out on to Imperial Institute Road (now Imperial College Road). © Groundsure. 2019.

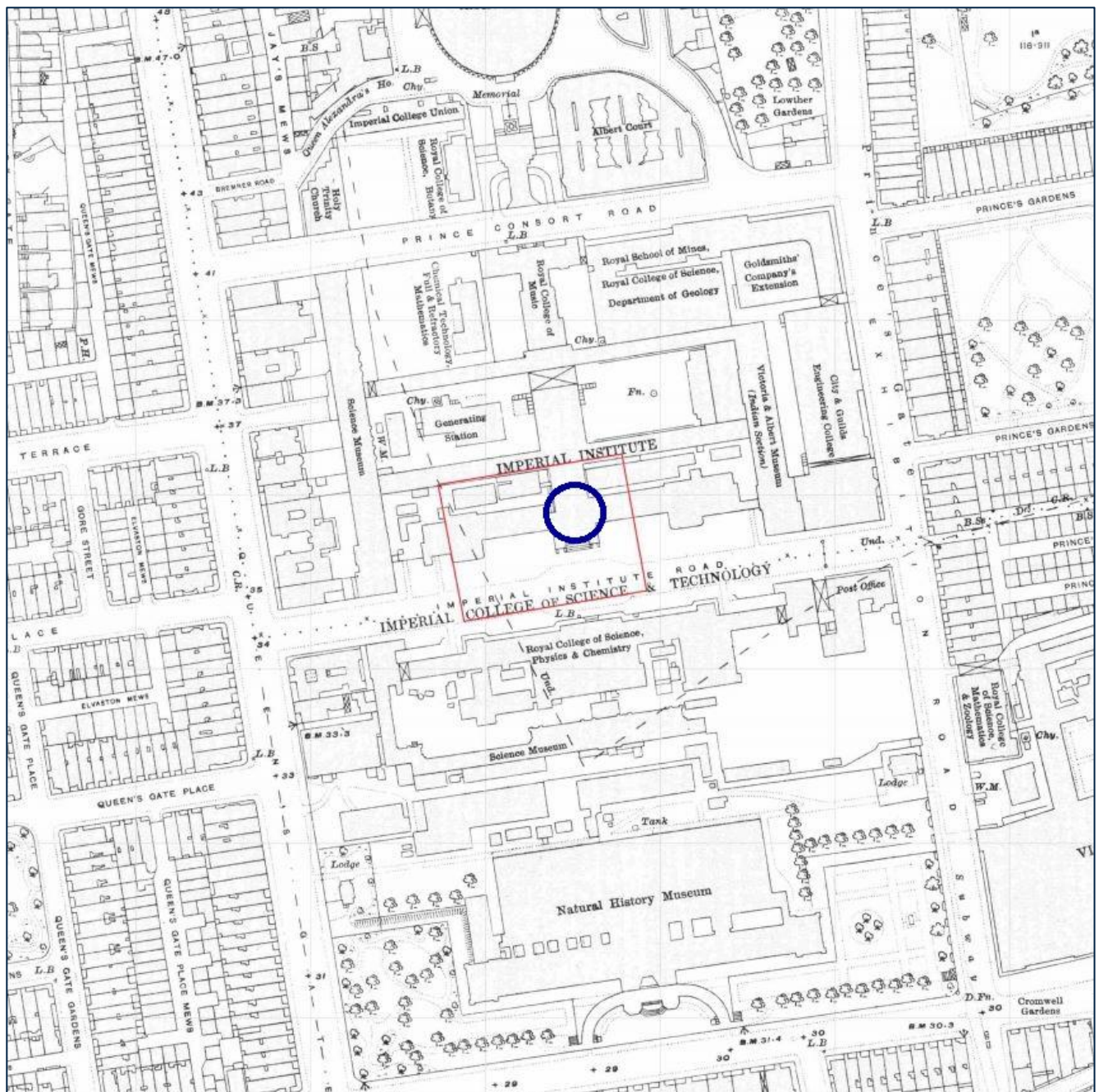


Figure 7 The 1916 Ordnance Survey illustrates alterations and additions to the Imperial Institute building that began to infill its rear open spaces. The Site is outlined here in red, and the location of the Grade II listed tower circled in blue. There is evidence of further development within the wider setting, with extensions to the Natural History Museum and development to the south of the Royal Albert Hall. © Groundsure. 2019.

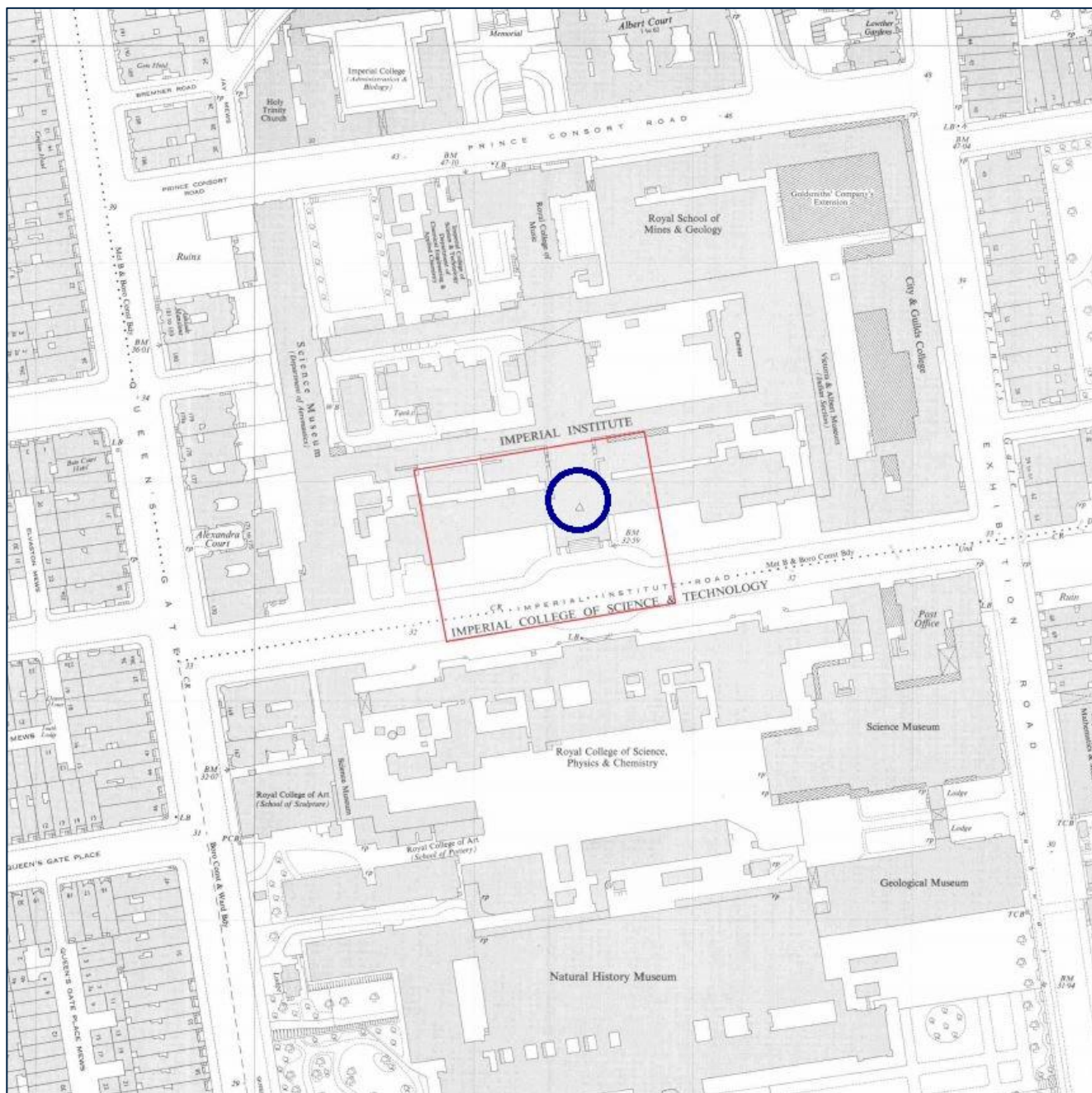


Figure 8 The Ordnance Survey of 1949-1951 demonstrates little to no change to the built form of the Imperial Institute by this time, which had already begun to decline and merged with numerous Government departments before relocating to a property at Holland Park. The Government announced an expansion of Imperial College London and caused much agitation when it was revealed that the Imperial Institute was to be demolished as part of the plans. © Groundsure. 2019.

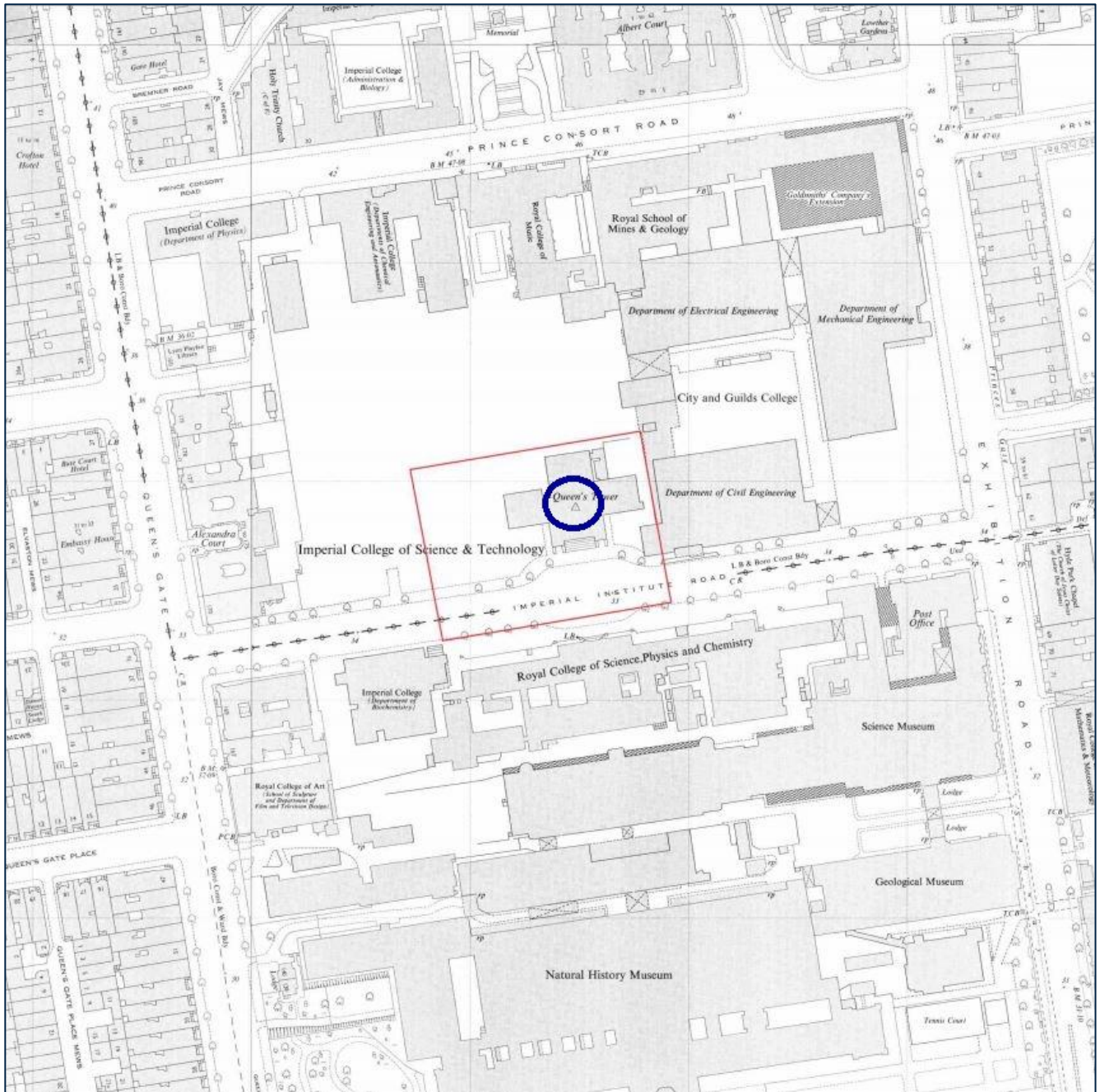


Figure 9 The 1965-68 Ordnance Survey illustrates the extent of the demolition of the Institute, with the entire western range of the main block cleared and the eastern section also demolished and replaced with new buildings. It was decided to retain the central tower, which would have to be altered and stabilised at its lower levels to allow it to be freestanding. © Groundsure. 2019.

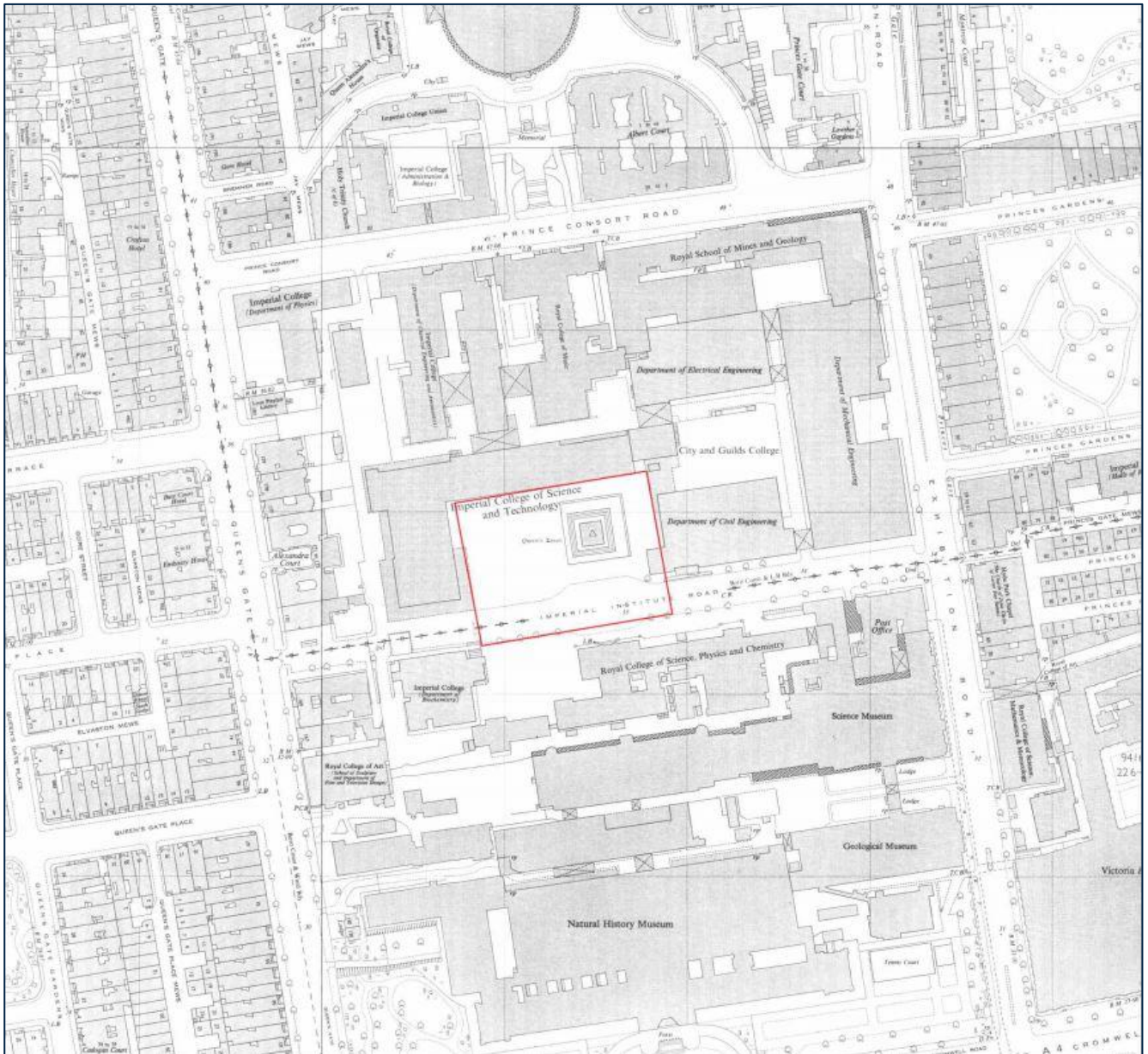


Figure 10 The 1968 Ordnance Survey showing the Site (outlined in red) now formed from redevelopment of the Imperial Institute site. The Queen's Tower had been altered to allow it to be freestanding and situated at the eastern side of the Site.
© Groundsure. 2019.



Figure 11 The 1991 Ordnance Survey which demonstrates the Site (outlined in red) much as it is today. The proposed works include landscaping of the Queen's Lawn and section of Imperial College Road to form a new public realm to be named Dangoor Plaza. © Groundsure. 2019.



Plate 2 A photograph c.1895 looking north east to the Imperial Institute along its principal south façade with the copper domed central tower visible towards the right of the image. Colcutt's design gave the impression of a much grander scale than was actually the reality.

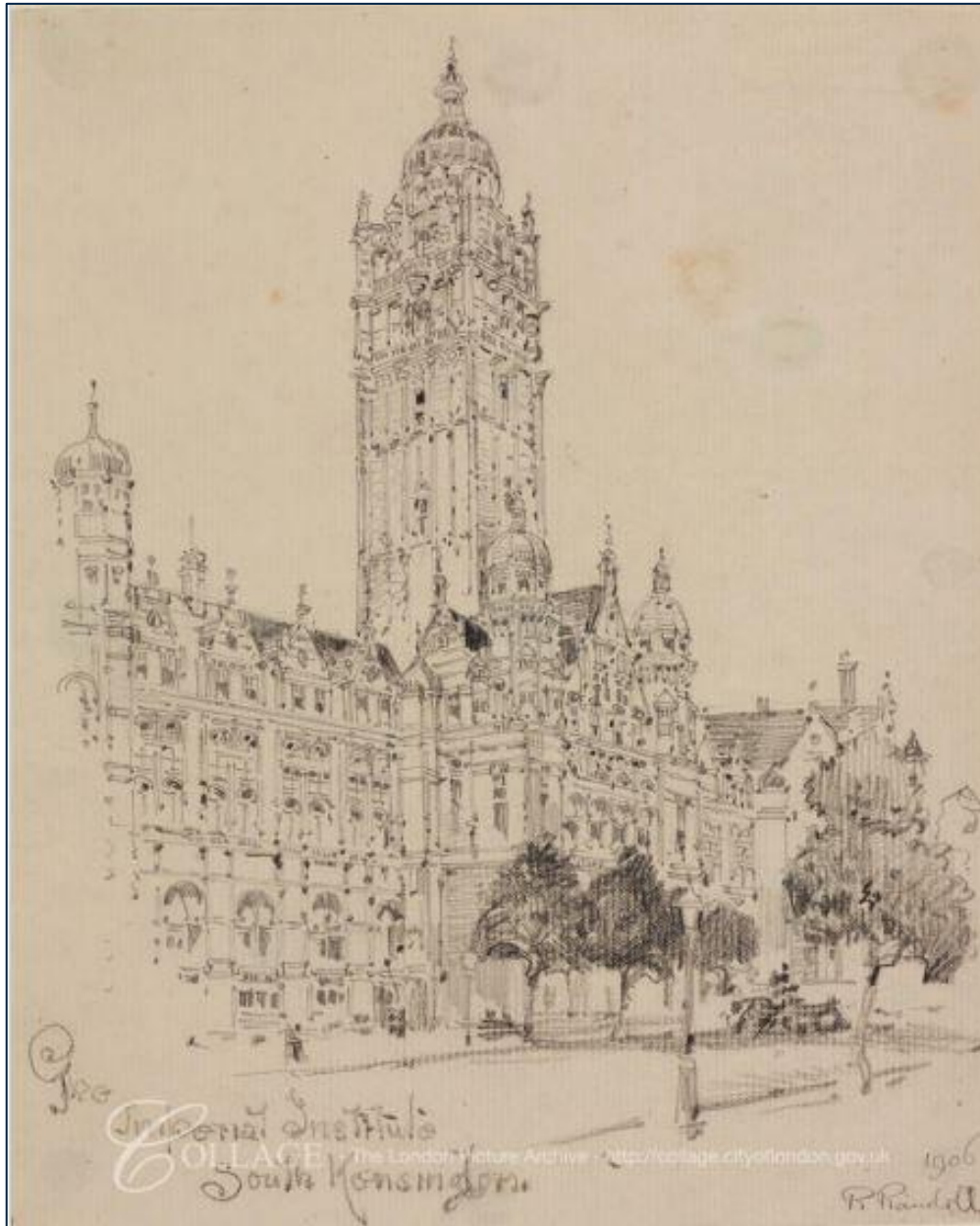


Plate 3 A pencil sketch by Robert Randoll c.1906 of the south elevation of the Imperial Institute, including the central tower, now known as Queen's Tower. The trees that lined Imperial Institute Road (now Imperial College Road) are still a feature that remain today and make a positive contribution to the setting of the Grade II listed tower and Queensgate Conservation Area.



Plate 4 A 1951 photograph looking north west along the principal façade of the Imperial Institute prior to its demolition. The Queen's Tower with its copper dome can be seen towards the left of the image and is all that remains of T.E. Colcutt's neo-Renaissance design.



Plate 5 View looking east across Queen's Lawn towards Queen's Tower, a Grade II listed heritage asset and the last remaining feature of the Imperial Institute. The lower level and base of the tower are mid-20th century alterations and interventions that allow the tower to be freestanding, but are not judged to detract from the special historic interest of the building. The surrounding buildings of Imperial College London are judged to make no contribution to the setting or significance of the heritage asset.



Plate 6 View looking west along Imperial College Road, which currently provides a thoroughfare for vehicles and vehicular parking, which creates a cluttered aesthetic within the area. The proposals seek to restrict vehicular access at this section of the road and limit parking to allow an improved pedestrian access across the Site. The trees are judged to make a positive contribution to the setting of the tower and the Queensgate Conservation Area and are to be retained as part of the proposals.



Plate 7 View looking north west from the southern boundary of the Site towards the mid-20th century buildings of Imperial College London, which are judged to make no contribution to the setting or significance of the Grade II listed tower or Queensgate Conservation Area.



Plate 8 View looking north west along Exhibition Road towards the early-21st century development for Imperial College London. Exhibition Road underwent extensive landscaping works, including within the Queensgate Conservation Area.



Plate 9 View looking west down Imperial College Road, a tree-lined street that provides a vehicular thoroughfare connecting through to Queen's Gate further west. The proposals retain the trees and seek to introduce a more cohesive landscape scheme that uses high quality materials that are sympathetic to the wider area and the Queensgate Conservation Area.



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